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Barriers' removal puzzles cyclists

City cites repairs, but some see an ulterior motive

By Shannon Larson
GLOBE STAFF

From the streets of upscale Back Bay to an industrial stretch of Massachusetts Avenue, bicyclists are encountering a new challenge: The bike lanes in both parts of Boston have been stripped of the barriers that offer some separation from the traffic whizzing by just a few feet away..

The flexible-post bollards that lined the green bikeways along Arlington Street, from the Park Plaza Hotel to a busy intersection by Boston Common, have been removed. And, along a particularly dangerous spot on Mass. Ave. in the Newmarket area, modular concrete strips several inches high were removed by city crews. The bike lane on Summer Street in the Seaport also no longer has protection.

"It's scary because with the posts up, I felt much safer. And now with them gone, I've seen cars drive in those lanes," said Robert Stinson, an accountant in his 50s who lives in Bay Village. "I've had cars honk at me as if I'm in the wrong lane."

The removals have set off alarm bells among cyclists who regularly navigate Boston's notorious traffic. With no apparent public announcement prior to the changes, cyclists have been left to speculate about the reasons, especially since they occurred just days after Josh Kraft used his mayoral campaign announcement to call for pausing all new bike lanes.

In a statement sent to the Globe on Friday afternoon, Boston Mayor Michelle Wu's press office said the flexposts on Arlington Street were "removed for

BARRIERS, Page A10



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Protective barriers were removed from this bike lane on Arlington Street.

\$400m pulled from Columbia

White House says N.Y. university fails to protect Jewish students

By Mike Damiano
and Hilary Burns
GLOBE STAFF

In an escalation of its crackdown on universities, the Trump administration pulled about \$400 million of funding from Columbia University on Friday, over what it described as the school's failure to protect Jewish students from harassment and antisemitism.

The funding cut is an extraordinary maneuver in President Trump's widening campaign to reshape American higher education, and opens a new chapter in

the turmoil that has shaken elite universities, including Harvard University and the Massachusetts Institute of Technology, since the beginning of the Israel-Hamas war. It also raises the prospect that other institutions could soon face similar sanctions.

Some advocates praised the funding cut. It is "forceful action" against antisemitism "at a speed that is completely unprecedented," said Kenneth Marcus, an official in the first Trump administration who is now founder and chairman of the Brandeis Center, a Jewish advocacy

group.

But Steven Levitsky, a Harvard government professor who has defended pro-Palestinian students' protest rights, sees it as part of a broader campaign to undermine higher education.

"They are coming after the universities and they are using antisemitism as an easily available weapon," he said. "The attacks are coming."

The cancellation of some of Columbia's government grants and contracts delivers on a threat Trump made on the campaign

COLUMBIA, Page A6



STANDING UP FOR SCIENCE

More than 500 people gathered outside the State House in Boston Friday to protest the Trump administration's funding cuts to scientific research, layoffs at federal science agencies, and other actions they say imperil medical progress and the economy. Similar rallies were held across the country and around the world. **B1.**

ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

As Virginia bears brunt of DOGE cuts, voters will choose new state leadership

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — When she launched her campaign for governor of Virginia just over a year ago, Abigail Spanberger, a former Democratic congresswoman, had a fairly straightforward set of priorities: education, cost of living, the housing crisis.

Since Jan. 20, that list has been upended.

"Now the issues that matter most to Virginians are, you know, whether or not they're gonna have a job tomorrow," Spanberger told the Globe.

As President Trump and his ally Elon Musk continue their push to rapidly dismantle the federal government through deep cuts to its workforce, few states stand to be more affected than Virginia, home

to over 340,000 federal workers, from the suburbs just across the Potomac River from Washington to the military communities of Hampton Roads.

And no state might illustrate the potential political backlash to the Department of Government Efficiency project quicker than Virginia, which is one of two to hold its gubernatorial and legislative elections the year after a presidential election. Virginia is always closely watched as a bellwether for a newly elected president's political fortunes. But this year, it's also a test of Trump and Musk's bid to radically reshape the government.

Democrats don't think DOGE's potentially outsized impact on Virginia will, on its own, ensure victory for them this November, but they

DOGE, Page A7

Rubio clashed with Musk at meeting with Cabinet — as president looked on

By Jonathan Swan
and Maggie Haberman
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — Marco Rubio was incensed. Here he was in the Cabinet Room of the White House, the secretary of state, seated beside the president and listening to a litany of attacks from the richest man in the world.

Seated diagonally opposite, across the elliptical mahogany table, Elon Musk was letting Rubio have it, accusing him of failing to slash his staff.

You have fired "nobody," Musk told Rubio, then scornfully added that perhaps the only person he had fired was a staff member from Musk's Department of Government Efficiency.

Rubio had been privately furious with Musk for weeks, ever

since his team effectively shuttered an entire agency that was supposedly under Rubio's control: the US Agency for International Development. But, in the extraordinary Cabinet meeting in front of President Trump and around 20 others — details of which have not been reported before — Rubio got his grievances off his chest.

Musk was not being truthful, Rubio said. What about the more than 1,500 State Department officials who took early retirement in buyouts? Didn't they count as layoffs? He asked, sarcastically, whether Musk wanted him to rehire all those people just so he could make a show of firing them again. Then he laid out his detailed plans for reorganizing the State Department.

MUSK, Page A7



It's that time

Daylight saving time starts early Sunday morning. Turn your clocks ahead one hour.

Gust in time

Saturday: Blustery, chilly. High: 41-46. Low: 26-31.

Sunday: Sun, still chilly. High: 40-45. Low: 30-35.

Sunrise: 6:08 Sunset: 5:43

Comics and Weather, **D4-5.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

Fletcher "Flash" Wiley was recalled as "a star" at the funeral for the prominent Boston attorney who shattered racial barriers. **B1.**

US employers added a solid 151,000 jobs last month, but the outlook is cloudy. **D1.**

Actor Gene Hackman and his wife, Betsy Arakawa, died from natural causes, authorities said. **A10.**

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'They're going to teams that we are jealous of'

DON SWEENEY, Bruins general manager, speaking about the players who were traded

Bruins make seismic shift to a rebuild

Captain Marchand traded away, along with Carlo and Coyle

By Jim McBride
GLOBE STAFF

With his team reeling, general manager Don Sweeney made some seismic changes to the Bruins roster Friday, trading away franchise stalwarts Brad Marchand, Brandon Carlo, and Charlie Coyle on deadline day.

Sweeney's shocking sell-off came a day after the Bruins fell to 28-28-8 on the season. With 64 points, Boston sits seventh in the Atlantic Division and is currently out of the playoff picture.

Marchand is heading to Florida, Carlo to Toronto, and Coyle to Colorado, meaning all three are now in the thick of the Stanley Cup chase.

The moves, which came in a flurry before the 3 p.m. deadline, follow Sweeney dealing Trent Frederic and Max Jones to Edmonton and Justin Brazeau to Minnesota earlier in the week.

Most stunning was the departure of Marchand, the club's captain for the last two seasons. He will now play for a Panthers team that knocked the Bruins out of the Stanley

BRUINS, Page C4



MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Brad Marchand and Charlie Coyle, along with teammate Brandon Carlo, won't be wearing the black and gold any longer this season.